



THE HIGH LIFE

The sky is the limit for youngsters these days. Two ambitious teenagers are battling for titles on the world's tallest peak. **Arjun Vajpai**, 16, wants to be the youngest Indian to scale Mt Everest. And there's more. He plans to conquer major peaks across seven continents before joining the army. One step at a time.



Bhagyashree Sawant, 18, is trying to topple **Krushnaa Patil** from the title of India's youngest woman to scale Everest. This national athlete will be using all her muscle power from years of rugby, cycling and karate training to reach the top. This one promises to be a cliffhanger.



RAAJ TALE

She was last seen as a young Kareena Kapoor in *Kabhi Khushi Kabhi Gham*. Now 19-year-old **Malvika Raaj** is all grown up and ready to compete with 17 other finalists for the Miss India title. This commerce student has already been walking on the ramp before she was selected for the contest. She's also hoping to make a comeback in Bollywood. "It's my childhood dream to act but after K3G, my father wanted me to focus on my studies," she says. The Bollywood connection goes beyond her dreams. Her father happens to be film producer Bobby Raaj and her aunt is former actor Anita Raaj. No wonder she has got her eyes set on the big screen.

At Sixes and Sevens

If all else fails, turn to the gods. The drubbing of her Kings XI Punjab team sent **Preity Zinta** running to dive into the Ganga. When she emerged cleansed of her sins, she dove straight for the blessings of Chandraswami. The tantrik may be accused of fraud but his halo of controversies does not seem to bother Zinta. As long as it works, she should pray for her film career too.



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Card Sharp

Americans might be knee-deep in debt but Indian American **Ajay Banga** will be encouraging them to spend more. The newly named CEO of MasterCard has hit the jackpot with his new role. And he's probably thanking his stars that he moved out from Citigroup in the midst of an economic storm. The key to his success? In India, we'd like to think it was his Indian education.

